

Quota Sampling Research Task

1. Introduction

Sampling is an important part of survey and research studies because researchers usually cannot collect information from every member of a population. Instead, they select a smaller group called a sample. Quota sampling is one method used to make sure that specific groups within a population are represented in the sample.

2. Definition of Quota Sampling

Quota sampling is a **non-probability sampling method** in which a researcher divides the target population into subgroups based on selected characteristics, sets a specific number of participants required from each subgroup, and then recruits participants until each quota is reached. The selection within the groups is not random.

3. Type of Sampling

Sampling type	Non-Probability Sampling
Selection	Non-random
Main idea	Fill predetermined quotas for selected subgroups

4. How Quota Sampling Works

- **Step 1:** Define the target population and identify important characteristics, such as age, gender, occupation, or study program.
- **Step 2:** Divide the population into subgroups, also called strata.
- **Step 3:** Set a quota, meaning the required number or proportion of participants from each subgroup.
- **Step 4:** Recruit participants using a non-random method, such as approaching available people or using an online survey.
- **Step 5:** Continue collecting responses until every quota is filled.

5. Example

Suppose a university wants to survey 100 students about satisfaction with online learning. The researcher decides that the sample should contain 50 first-year students and 50 second-year students. The researcher approaches available students and collects responses until 50 students from each year group have participated. This is quota sampling because the researcher sets the quotas in advance and selects participants non-randomly.

6. Advantages

- It is relatively quick and easy to conduct because it does not require a complete list of the population or a strict random-selection process.
- It can ensure that important subgroups are represented in the sample.

- It allows researchers to compare different subgroups more easily because each group has a planned number of participants.

7. Disadvantages

- Because participants are not selected randomly, the sample can suffer from selection or sampling bias.
- The results may not be fully generalizable to the whole population.
- The sample may appear balanced on the selected characteristics while still differing from the population in other important characteristics.

8. Conclusion

Quota sampling is a non-probability sampling technique that helps researchers obtain a sample containing predetermined numbers or proportions of people from selected subgroups. It is useful when researchers need results quickly or when random sampling is difficult. However, because participant selection is non-random, researchers must consider the possibility of sampling bias and should be careful when generalizing the findings to the entire population.

9. References

1. Scribbr. "What Is Quota Sampling? Definition & Examples." Revised June 22, 2023.
2. Scribbr. "Sampling Methods: Types, Techniques & Examples." Revised June 22, 2023.
3. Statistics By Jim. "Quota Sampling: Definition & Examples."